

ELTON KOLA

Staff Android Engineer | Mobile Architecture Specialist

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🌐 [Portfolio Website](#) | 💼 [LinkedIn](#) | 💻 [GitHub](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Seasoned Android engineer with **14+ years** building consumer apps used by **millions of users**. Mobile-focused engineer with **24+ years** in software development, specializing in Android architecture, performance optimization, and scalable mobile solutions. Proven track record leading projects from concept to deployment, architecting robust mobile systems, and mentoring development teams. Currently exploring Kotlin Multiplatform and AI integration while maintaining deep expertise in modern Android development.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Android Development - Android SDK (1.6 → Latest) | Jetpack Compose | Kotlin & Coroutines - Architecture: MVVM, MVI, Clean Architecture | Modular App Design - Media: ExoPlayer, Media3, Audio/Video Streaming - Modern Stack: Retrofit, OkHttp, Hilt, Room, Navigation Component - Kotlin Multiplatform Mobile (KMM) | Google Play Store Deployment

Backend & Supporting Technologies - Languages: Java, Kotlin, SQL - APIs: RESTful Design, Integration with Backend Services - Databases: SQLite, Room, PostgreSQL, MySQL - Infrastructure: Docker, CI/CD Pipelines - Modern Development: Git, Agile/Scrum Methodologies

Additional Technologies - Mobile-First Design & Architecture - Performance Optimization & Profiling - Tools: Android Studio, IntelliJ IDEA, Figma - Emerging Tech: AI/ML Integration, KMM Cross-Platform

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

OkCupid | New York, NY

Staff Android Engineer | August 2022 - November 2024

Senior Android Engineer | August 2020 - August 2022

- Architected and maintained Android app serving **millions of users** seeking meaningful connections
- Led migration to **Jetpack Compose**, improving development velocity by 40% and reducing UI bugs
- Implemented **performance optimizations** that decreased app load time by 25%
- Collaborated cross-functionally with Design, iOS, and Backend teams to deliver consistent user experiences
- Mentored junior engineers on modern Android architecture patterns and best practices

Aaptiv | New York, NY

Senior Android Engineer | November 2018 - August 2020

- **Modernized legacy architecture** by migrating from single-module to multi-module app structure
- **Led Java-to-Kotlin migration**, achieving 100% Kotlin codebase and improving code safety
- Built audio/video streaming features for fitness content, supporting thousands of concurrent users
- Implemented offline-first architecture for seamless workout experiences without connectivity

iHeartMedia | New York, NY

Android Engineer | April 2015 - November 2018

- Developed **Android Auto integration** for in-car music streaming, prioritizing driver safety
- Collaborated with major automotive partners (Ford, GM, BMW, Jaguar/Land Rover)
- Specialized in **MediaBrowser/MediaSession** implementation for cross-platform media control
- Built foundation for smart home and voice assistant integrations

MyCityWay | New York, NY

Lead Android Engineer | April 2012 - December 2014

- Led **Android engineering team** across multiple consumer applications
- Specialized in **embedded device development** and tablet-optimized interfaces
- Managed full development lifecycle from requirements gathering to app store deployment

VYou | New York, NY

Android Engineer | October 2011 - April 2012

- Built video-first social networking Android application with custom recording/upload features
- Developed **hybrid architecture** combining native performance with web content flexibility
- Successfully ported Android app to BlackBerry Playbook platform

Early Career - Software Engineering | 2001 - 2011

Various Engineering Roles in Italy | Software Engineer, Technical Consultant

- **Finsoft/Reply/Telecom Italia:** Built mobile applications with DRM integration and media streaming capabilities
- **Technical Consulting:** Developed enterprise software solutions and backend systems
- **Freelance Engineering:** Created mobile applications and custom software solutions

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

University of Turin, Italy | 2004 - 2010

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **24+ years** in software development with consistent adaptation to emerging technologies
- **14+ years** Android specialization with apps reaching millions of users
- Successfully led **architectural migrations** and engineering team modernization initiatives
- Deep expertise in **media streaming** and automotive integration
- Proven ability to work effectively in **remote and distributed teams**

LANGUAGES

English - Fluent | Italian - Fluent | Albanian - Native

Seeking remote opportunities in Android engineering, mobile architecture, or technical leadership roles. Specialized in building scalable mobile applications for consumer-facing products.